B.Ed. (1.5 Years)

CITIZENSHIP EDUCATION AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

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Department of Early Childhood Education & Elementary Teacher Education
Faculty of Education
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FOREWARD

Education prepares young people for entry into society and is thus a form of socialization, for this purpose teacher plays a crucial role in the development of community. Someone once said that if you want to study the nature of the citizens of the country then meet some teachers and study their nature. After all, the community is a replica of teachers living in it. Teachers help students transform into good citizens with a positive attitude, confidence and motivation to pursue excellence.

Keeping in view the tremendous role of teachers, Allama Iqbal Open University is making strenuous efforts to prepare competent teachers and professionals from primary to higher level of education. For this purpose, Faculty of Education is offering different courses to cope with the requirements of our schools by emphasizing ethnical and professional standards, informed decision making, reflective practice, pedagogical knowledge, diversity, content knowledge, effective communications and technological competence. Particularly citizenship education and community engagement is new and introductory course in teacher education programme and provide a historical, sociological and philosophical perspective on education. This course is designed to provide an opportunity to develop awareness about linkage among school, community and teacher for effective education programme. Through this course students will have an exploration of interaction between teaching and learning within school and community.

While students are provided with important knowledge pertaining to the role of community, engagement and citizenship education the course requires students to take an active part in thinking about the goals and purposes of education. So as a learner of this course prospective teachers are expected to demonstrate developing competence in all of these areas.

So I congratulate Dr. Naveeda Sultana, Associate Professor, Secondary Teacher Education Department and her team members for their professional input and efforts and all those involved in the development of this course.

Prof. Dr. Shahid Siddiqui

Vice Chancellor

INTRODUCTION

Education modifies the behaviour of person, thus education can perform this duty well if the system of education runs effectively. For making the education system successful teachers play an important role for implementing the different components of education. It has become the dire need of the society to make teachers well conversant about the requirements of the society.

It is clear that teacher makes a tremendous contribution to our society. A teacher is the one who shapes the personality and entire life of children. It is one of the noble professions as it contributes in building the future of the country and overall society. Teachers play a significant and valuable role as they influence the lives of children who are the future. Students get influenced by the teacher's character, his/her affection and commitment, his/her competence and his/her morals and ethics. So it is important that only the best and the intelligent human beings are allowed to become teachers so that a safe future is ensured. The role of a teacher in education system is pivotal. He is the implementer of society and the yardstick that decides the quality of education system. Successful teachers enjoy working with children, managing and motivating people, working well with the community.

The course emphasized how to experience the social contact with the community, and how to mobilize community for the development of the school. The course includes wider issues including culture, gender, special needs, equity and equality and collaborative working condition within the school and community. This course will provide an orientation for the process of socialization and social development. It also emphasize on social factors which may affect education. This course has not only a theoretical perspective but some practical aspects as well, like community work, improving social interaction activities, and promotion of healthy environment. This course contains nine units. Unit-1 covers the nature, characteristics, and functions of society and culture and cultural diversity. Unit-2 highlights the nature, role and dynamics of group. Unit-3 describes the concept, aims, factors and responsible agencies of socialization. Unit-4 focuses on social institutions. Unit-5 addresses the concept, methods and role of school and teacher in social control. Unit-6 highlights the relationship of school, society and teacher. Unit-7 covers the effective role of teacher. Unit-8 highlights the technological change and its impact on society. And Unit-9 describes collaboration between school and community while covering the community development theory, objectives for collaboration, collaboration plans, involvement of parents and effective communication mechanism.

We wish to express our indebtedness to the writers and reviewers who put their ideas and efforts in the preparation of this course. We all are thankful to the leadership of AIOU whose commitment to quality education and encouraging attitude enabled the course development team to accomplish the task in a more congenial environment. Even then man made things always posses the chance of mistake so any criticism and suggestions for the improvement and revision of next volume will be welcomed.

Dr. Naveeda Sultana
Chairperson
Secondary Teacher Education Department

OBJECTIVES

The course is designed for the prospective teachers of B.Ed. Many researchers have highlighted the need of relationship between the education and community. The community is the base and schools are to create the healthy and conducive relationship between the community and citizens. The philosophy behind the schools is to prepare individuals that are well aware of the community needs and work for the benefit of other citizens of the community. Teacher is the major component of the school, without teacher a school is just a building, here teacher shapes the individuals' behaviours. Keeping in view the above mentioned facts, it was felt that a course that enlightens the basic relationship between citizenship education and community engagement is mandatory for the teacher education programme.

After completion of the course, the prospective teachers will be expected to:

- discuss relation between citizenship education and community engagement.
- describe the process of socialization and social development.
- identify the social factors affecting education and how it can support the development of education.
- explore the role of teachers and school in socialization of students and development of community.
- exhibit the role of different groups and agencies in community engagement.
- identify the role of technology in community.

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